

6. Project Leadership, Ethics & Closure

Q.1 Explain the importance of ethics in Project.

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- Ethics are crucial in PM because they influence every part of the project. From decision-making to team performance and final success.

Importance

- 1) Ethical behavior
- 2) Building Trust
- 3) Effective leadership
- 4) Project success

		Effective	Project success.
	Building	Leadership	
Ethical behavior	Trust		

1) Ethical behavior

⇒ Ethics is about making the best decisions concerning people, trust resources, and the environment.

- It ensures fairness, responsibility and respect in all project dealings.
- Enhances transparency and accountability within the team.

2) Building Trust

⇒ Trust is essential for collaboration. Ethical behavior helps build trust among team members, stakeholders, and clients, which is vital for project cohesion and communication.

3) Effective leadership

⇒ Trust from ethical behavior results in stronger leadership.

- Ethical leaders motivate teams with integrity and vision.
- Drives respect and loyalty, ensuring smoother project execution.

4) Project success

⇒ When leadership is built on trust and ethics, projects are more likely to succeed.

- Teams feel secure, stakeholder remains engaged and risks are minimized through transparent decision making.

Q.2 How ethics in projects are looked upon for successful government's project completion? Illustrate with example.

- ⇒
- Ethics plays a critical role in the success of government projects by ensuring fairness, transparency, accountability and public trust.
 - Government projects often involve public funds and resources, and thus ethical conduct is not just important - it is essential.
 - Importance

1) Transparency and Accountability

- ⇒ Ensures public funds are used appropriately.
- Prevents corruption, favoritism, and misuse of resources.
 - Builds public confidence in government operations.

2) Compliance with Laws and Regulations

- ⇒ Ethical project management ensures adherence to procurement laws, environmental guidelines and labor rights.
- Avoids legal penalties and delays due to non-compliance.

3) Stakeholder Trust and Engagement

- ⇒ Promotes citizens involvement and trust in public services.
- Facilitates smooth collaboration between departments, contractors and communities.

Example: Delhi Metro Project

The Delhi Metro Rail project is a shining example of ethical project management in the public sector.

Ethical Practices observed:

- i) Zero tolerance for corruption
- ii) Transparent bidding and procurement processes.
- iii) Strong internal audits and timely reporting.
- iv) Fair treatment of workers and strict safety norms.

Result:

- i) Project completed on time and within budget.
- ii) Gain widespread public trust and become a model for other infrastructure projects across India and abroad.

Q.3 Explain multicultural and virtual projects

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1) Multicultural Projects

- In any project where a person or group of people working brings different assumption in the work i.e. either in product development or team behavior is called as multicultural project.
- The project manager may have to deal with participants from different cultures and their expectations and behaviors.
- Multicultural projects require more formal requirements and architecture reviews than other projects.
- The formalism here helps to reduce the risk of communication problem.
- Major Problems

a) Communication barriers

⇒ Language and communication styles may differ. Managers should choose a common communication method everyone understands.

b) Building Trust

⇒ Hard to establish trust initially due to cultural and geographic gaps.

- Managers should encourage open discussion and regularly check for concerns to build trust.

2) Virtual Projects

⇒ A virtual project is a project in which team members are dispersed geographically and potentially on other dimensions and are working together to accomplish a specific task under time and resource constraints.

- These projects rely heavily on technology for coordination.

- Technology helps to create the "virtual workspace" that the team uses to communicate and collaborate.

- Major Problems

a) Time differences

⇒ If you are across the world from all of your employees, chances aren't are you aren't working the same hours.

- This can be difficult.

b) Miscommunication

⇒ Lack of face-to-face interaction can lead to misunderstanding.

- When these miscommunications occurs, project managers have to find a diplomatic solutions that reinforces a strong team bond.

Q.4 List and briefly describe the ways project may be terminated? What are some non-technical reasons for project termination?

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- Project termination is one of the most serious decisions a project management team and its control board have to make.
- Project termination is the process of formally ending all activities related to the project.
- It occurs when the project has either reached its objectives or can no longer continue due to various reasons.

Types of Project Termination

- 1) Termination by extinction
- 2) Termination by addition
- 3) Termination by integration
- 4) Termination by starvation

1) Termination by extinction

⇒ The project may be stopped because it has been either successful or unsuccessful.

- Examples of successful projects include the launch of a software program, the completion of new school building.
- Unsuccessful projects may include a drug manufacture that has failed efficacy test, a project that is no longer cost-effective.

2) Termination by addition

⇒ This is where a project is made more or less an external, but full-fledged addition to the parent organization.

- For example, a new department of a university could be built as an extension of existing university facilities to operate with substantial independence from other segments of the institution.

3) Termination by integration

⇒ This is the most common way of dealing with successful projects, and the most complex ones.

- The output of the project becomes part-and-parcel of the operating systems of the partner or parent or client.
- This requires thorough integration with primary operations at various levels distributing the output among existing functions.

4) Termination by starvation

⇒ As the term suggests, the financial, human and material resources needed to execute the project are curtailed.

- The project is effectively dead and merely on minimal life-support system for legal reasons.
- For e.g., A project keeps getting reduced funding until it can no longer function.

• Non-technical reasons for Project Termination

- 1) Lack of senior management support
- 2) Poor planning
- 3) Wrong Project Manager
- 4) Market condition
- 5) Reputation Management

1) Lack of senior management support

⇒ A project needs ~~to be~~ strong support from top leadership to succeed.

- If senior managers don't provide enough attention, resources or decision-making power, the project may struggle and eventually shut down.

2) Poor planning

⇒ Without a clear plan, the project team may not know what to do, when to do it, or how to measure success.

- This leads to confusion, delays and missed goals, making the project likely to fail.

3) Wrong Project Manager

⇒ A project manager plays a key role in guiding the team and managing the work.

- If the person lacks the necessary skills, experience or leadership qualities, the project may go off track or lose direction.

4) Market Conditions

⇒ Shifts in market conditions, such as changes in consumer demand or competitive landscape, may necessitate the termination of projects.

5) Reputation Management

⇒ Projects may be terminated to avoid reputational damage, especially if they are associated with controversy or negative publicity.

Q.5 Lesson Learned Analysis

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- The lesson learned analysis is a technique through which we can learn from our mistakes and successes and maximize our performance over time.
- This is also known as the post-mortem analysis.
- Generally, this process is held near the completion of the project, but it's more beneficial to hold it during the course of projects.
- For example, when a milestone has been achieved, we can hold a lesson learned analysis and act based on the learning.
- There's no need to wait until the end to act, especially if lesson is something everyone can benefit from.
- Process:

1) Define the project

⇒ This is the initial step wherein the need for lessons learned analysis is identified and the process and team to collect lessons are established.

2) Collect

⇒ This step involves the collection of information through structured as well as unstructured processes such as project critiques, written forms and meetings.

- The collection of lessons may come from as many sources as an organization is willing to solicit.

3) Verify and Synthesize

⇒ In this step, the accuracy and applicability of lessons submitted are verified.

4) Store

⇒ In this step, the lessons learned are stored which usually involves incorporating lessons into an electronic database for future sharing and dissemination.

5) Disseminate

⇒ In this step, the lessons learned are stored which usually involves incorporating lessons into an

- The final and the most important element is dissemination of lessons learned.

Dissemination can include the revision of work process, training and routine distribution via a variety of communication media.